

1.6.1 Clairaut equations

A **Clairaut equation** is a differential equation of the form

$$y = xy' + \phi(y'), \quad (1.6.1)$$

where $\phi \in C^1(I)$.

We substitute $y' = p$, $p = p(x)$ and by differentiating with respect to x we obtain that

$$p'(x + \phi'(p)) = 0.$$

So, a possible case is $p' = 0$ which becomes

$$y = Cx + \psi(C). \quad (1.6.2)$$

The second case is

$$\begin{cases} x = -\phi'(p) \\ y = -p\phi'(p) + \phi(p) \end{cases}. \quad (1.6.3)$$

The solution (1.6.2) represents the **general solution** of the Clairaut equation, and the parametric solution (1.6.3) is the **singular solution** of the Clairaut equation.

The singular solution (1.6.3) can not be obtained from (1.6.2) by assigning a particular value to the constant C , because the singular solution represents the envelope of the family of straight lines given by the general solution (1.6.2).

 **Example 1.6.1** Find the solutions of the differential equation $y = xy' + \sin y'$.

 **Solution:** We substitute $y' = p$, and the equation becomes $y = xp + \sin p$. Differentiating with respect to x we have:

$$p = p + p'x + p' \cos p, \text{ that is } p'(x + \cos p) = 0.$$

The first case is $p' = 0$, that means $p = C$, and we have the general solution

$$y = xC + \sin C, \quad C \in \mathbb{R}.$$

From the second case we have the parametric solution

$$\begin{cases} x = -\cos p \\ y = -p \cos p + \sin p \end{cases}.$$



 **Example 1.6.2** Integrate the equation $y + y' \ln y' = xy'$.

 **Solution:** We write the equation in the form $y = xy' - y' \ln y'$.

Substituting $y' = p$ the equation becomes $y = xp - p \ln p$, and differentiating the new equation with respect to x we have

$$p'(x - 1 - \ln p) = 0.$$

The general solution is

$$y = xC - C \ln C, \quad C \in \mathbb{R}_+,$$

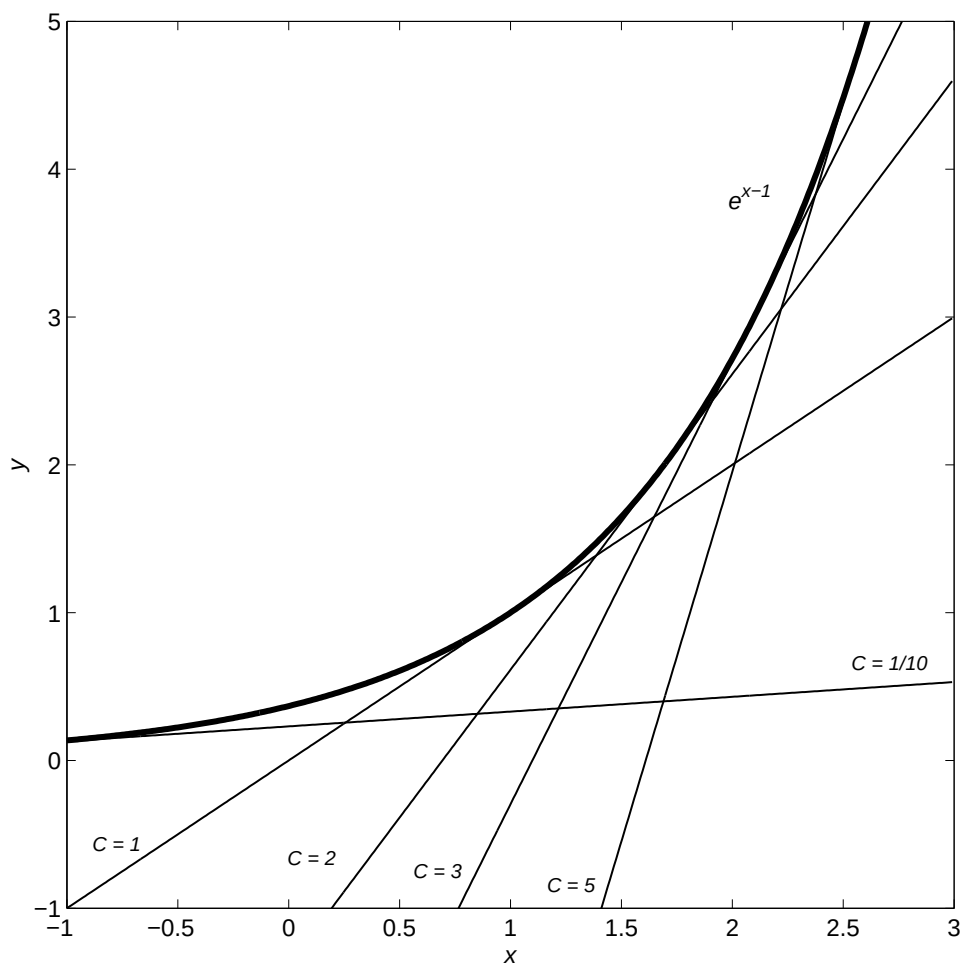
and the singular solution is

$$\begin{cases} x = 1 + \ln p, & p > 0 \\ y = p \end{cases}.$$

Note that the parameter p can be eliminated and the singular integral can be written in the form

$$y = e^{x-1}.$$

In the following picture we represented a few solutions from the family of straight lines, for some values of the constant C , together with the particular solution. As we can see, the particular solution is indeed the envelope of the



Exercises

1.6.1 Find the solutions of the following differential equations:

i). $y = xy' + \frac{a}{y'^2}, a \in \mathbb{R}$

vi). $y = xy' + e^{-y'}$

ii). $y = xy' + \frac{ay'}{\sqrt{1+y'^2}}, a \in \mathbb{R}$

vii). $y = xy' - \frac{1}{3y'^2}$

iii). $y'^3 = 3(xy' - y)$

viii). $y = xy' + \cos^2 y'$

iv). $yy' = xy'^2 + 1$

ix). $y = xy' + a\sqrt{1+y'^2}$

v). $2y'^2(y - xy') = 1$

x). $y = xy' - y'^4$

1.6.2 Lagrange Equations

A **Lagrange equation** is an equation of the form

$$y = x\phi(y') + \psi(y'), \quad (1.6.4)$$

with $\phi, \psi \in C^1(I)$.

We substitute $y' = p$, $p = p(x)$, then differentiate the equation (1.6.4) with respect to x and obtain the linear equation of the first order with the unknown x and the independent variable p :

$$\frac{dx}{dp} = \frac{\phi'(p)}{p - \phi(p)}x + \frac{\psi'(p)}{p - \phi(p)}.$$

Solving this equation we obtain

$$x = F(p, C), \quad C \in \mathbb{R}, \quad (1.6.5)$$

and next

$$y = F(p, C)\phi(p) + \psi(p). \quad (1.6.6)$$

The relations (1.6.5), (1.6.6) represent **the parametric solution** of equation (1.6.4) with the real parameter p .

If $p - \phi(p) = 0$ has the solutions $p_i \in I$, then the equation (1.6.4) has **singular solutions** too, of the form $y = p_i x + \psi(p_i)$, and these solutions are straight lines.

 **Example 1.6.3** Find the solutions of the differential equation $y = (1 + y')x + e^{-y'}$.

 **Solution:** Substituting $y' = p$, the equation becomes $y = (1 + p)x + e^{-p}$ and, differentiating the equation with respect to x , we have $p = 1 + p + xp' - p'e^{-p}$, which means

$$-1 = p'(x - e^{-p}), \quad p' = \frac{dp}{dx}.$$

In what follows we consider the new equation as a differential equation of the first order in x ,

$$\frac{dx}{dp} + x = e^{-p} \text{ or } x' + x = e^{-p}$$

with the solution

$$x(p) = Ce^{-p} + pe^{-p}. \quad (1.6.7)$$

Next we have

$$y(p) = [(1+p)(C+p) + 1]e^{-p}. \quad (1.6.8)$$

and the relations (1.6.7)+(1.6.8) represent the parametric solution of the problem. In this case we don't have singular solutions. 

 **Example 1.6.4** Find the solutions of the differential equation $y = 2xy' + \sin y'$.

 **Solution:** Substituting $y' = p$ and differentiating the equation with respect to x , it becomes $-p = p'(2x + \cos p)$. Changing the role of the variables, we get

$$-p \frac{dx}{dp} - 2x = \cos p, \text{ or } x' + \frac{2}{p}x = -\frac{\cos p}{p}$$

with the particular solution $\begin{cases} x(p) = \frac{C}{p^2} - \frac{\sin p}{p} - \frac{\cos p}{p^2} \\ y(p) = 2\frac{C}{p} - 2\frac{\cos p}{p} - \sin p \end{cases}$. If $p = 0$, we have a singular solution $y = 0$. 



Exercises

 **1.6.2** Solve the following differential equations:

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|------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| i). $y = (1 + y')x + \cos(1 + y')$ | vi). $y = xy'^2 + y'^2$ |
| ii). $y = xy'^2 + 1 + y'^2$ | vii). $yy' = 2xy'^2 + 1$ |
| iii). $y - 2y'(x - \ln y') = 0$ | viii). $y = 2xy' + 1 + y'$ |
| iv). $y = \frac{3}{2}xy' + e^{y'}$ | ix). $y = (1 + y')(1 + x)$ |
| v). $y = 2xy' + \ln y'$ | x). $y = 2xy' + \sqrt{1 + y'^2}$ |

1.6.3 Implicit equations of the form $f(x, y') = 0$ that can be solved with respect to y or x

 **Example 1.6.5** Solve the equation $y = x + y' - \ln y'$.

 **Solution:** We replace $y' = p$, and the equation becomes $y = x + p - \ln p$. Differentiating we obtain that: $y' = 1 + p' - \frac{p'}{p}$, which gives $p = 1 + \frac{dp}{dx} - \frac{dp}{dx} \frac{1}{p}$, and $dx(p - 1) = dp \left(1 - \frac{1}{p}\right)$. Now we have the differential equation $x' = \frac{1}{p}$ with the solution $\begin{cases} x = \ln p + C \\ y = p + C \end{cases}$, $C \in \mathbb{R}$. 

If we have an equation of the form $f(x, y') = 0$ from which x can be determined explicitly, then we can write it in the form $x = \phi(y')$.

Replacing $y' = p$ we have

$$x = \phi(p) \text{ and } dx = \phi'(p) dp.$$

From $y' = p$, that is $\frac{dy}{dx} = p$, we have $dx = \frac{dy}{p}$ and replacing in the equation we obtain that:

$$\frac{dy}{p} = \phi'(p) dp, \quad dy = p\phi'(p) dp.$$

So $\begin{cases} y = \int p\phi'(p) dp + C \\ x = \phi(p) \end{cases}$ that is the solution given in parametric form.

 **Example 1.6.6** Solve the differential equation $x = \ln y' + \sin y'$

 **Solution:** We replace $y' = p$, so the equation becomes $x = \ln p + \sin p$. Now we differentiate and obtain: $dx = \frac{dp}{p} + \cos p dp$, $\frac{dy}{p} = \frac{dp}{p} + \cos p dp$, $dy = dp + p \cos p dp$. Next the solution is $\begin{cases} y = p + p \sin p + \cos p + C \\ x = \ln p + \sin p \end{cases}$, with $C \in \mathbb{R}$. 



Exercises

 **1.6.3** Solve the differential equations:

- i). $y = y'^2 + 3xy' + \frac{3}{2}x^2$ v). $x = y'^2 - 2y' + 2$
 ii). $y = -\frac{1}{3}(xy' + x^2 + y'^2)$ vi). $x = 2y' + \cos y'$
 iii). $y = y' \ln y'$ vii). $x = e^{y'} + y'$
 iv). $y' = e^{\frac{y'}{y}}$ viii). $x = y'^2 + \sqrt{y'}$
 ix). $y = ay'^2 + by'^3$, a, b , constants.



Answers

1.6.1 i) $y = xC + \frac{a}{C^2}$, $C \in \mathbb{R}^*$; $4y^3 - 27ax^3 = 0$; ii) $y = xC + \frac{aC}{\sqrt{1+C^2}}$, $C \in \mathbb{R}$; $x^{\frac{2}{3}} + y^{\frac{2}{3}} = a^{\frac{2}{3}}$; iii) $y = xC - \frac{1}{3}C^3$, $C \in \mathbb{R}$; $9y^2 = \frac{64}{27}x^3$; iv) $yC = xC^2 + 1$, $C \in \mathbb{R}$; $y^2 = 4x$; v) $2C^2(y - xC) = 1$, $C \in \mathbb{R}$; $8y^3 = 27x^2$; vi) $y = xC + e^{-C}$, $C \in \mathbb{R}$; $y = -x \ln|x| + x$; vii) $y = xC - \frac{1}{3C^2}$, $C \in \mathbb{R}^*$; $4y^3 + 9x^2 = 0$; viii) $y = xC + \cos^2 C$, $C \in \mathbb{R}$; $\begin{cases} x = \sin 2p \\ y = p \sin 2p + \cos^2 p \end{cases}$; ix) $y = xC + a\sqrt{1+C^2}$, $C \in \mathbb{R}$; $x^2 + y^2 = a^2$; x) $y = xC - C^4$, $C \in \mathbb{R}$; $27x^4 - 256y^3 = 0$.

1.6.2 i) $\begin{cases} x(p) = Ce^{-p} + \frac{1}{2}[\sin(1+p) - \cos(1+p)] \\ y(p) = C(1+p)e^{-p} + \frac{1}{2}(1+p)[\sin(1+p) + \cos(1+p)] \end{cases}$;
 ii) $\begin{cases} x(p) = \frac{C}{(1-p)^2} + \frac{2p-p^2}{(1-p)^2} \\ y(p) = xp^2 + 1 + p^2 \end{cases}$, $y = 1$, $y = x + 2$; iii) $\begin{cases} x(p) = \frac{C}{p^2} + \frac{1}{2} + \ln p \\ y(p) = \frac{2C}{p} + p \end{cases}$;
 iv) $\begin{cases} x(p) = \frac{C}{p^3} - \frac{e^{p(2p^2-4p+4)}}{p^3} \\ y(p) = \frac{3}{2}xp + e^p \end{cases}$, $y = 1$; v) $\begin{cases} x(p) = \frac{C}{p^2} - \frac{1}{p} \\ y(p) = \ln p + \frac{2C}{p} - 2 \end{cases}$;
 vi) $\begin{cases} x(p) = \frac{C}{(p-1)^2} - 1 \\ y(p) = \frac{Cp^2}{(p-1)^2} \end{cases}$, $y = 0$, $y = x + 1$; vii) $\begin{cases} x(p) = \frac{1}{p^2} \ln|p| + \frac{C}{p^2} \\ y(p) = 2xp + \frac{1}{p} \end{cases}$;
 viii) $\begin{cases} x(p) = \frac{C}{p^2} - \frac{1}{2} \\ y(p) = \frac{2C}{p} + 1 \end{cases}$, $y = 1$; ix) $\begin{cases} x(p) = Ce^{-p} - 1 \\ y(p) = (1+p)Ce^{-p} \end{cases}$;
 x) $\begin{cases} x(p) = \frac{C}{p^2} - \frac{1}{2p}\sqrt{1+p^2} + \frac{1}{2p^2} \ln \left| p + \sqrt{1+p^2} \right| \\ y(p) = 2xp + \sqrt{1+p^2} \end{cases}$, $y = 1$.

1.6.3 i) $y = -\frac{3}{4}x^2$ si $y = -\frac{1}{2}(-x+C)^2 + \frac{3}{2}C^2$, $C \in \mathbb{R}$;
 ii) $y = -\frac{x^2}{4}$ si $y = -\frac{1}{3}[x^2 + x(C-2x) + (C-2x)^2]$, $C \in \mathbb{R}$;
 iii) $\begin{cases} x = \frac{1}{2} \ln^2 p + \ln p + C \\ y = p \ln p \end{cases}$, $C \in \mathbb{R}$; iv) $\begin{cases} x = \ln|\ln p| + \frac{1}{\ln p} + C \\ y = \frac{p}{\ln p} \end{cases}$, $C \in \mathbb{R}$;

$$\begin{aligned}
\text{v)} \quad & \left\{ \begin{array}{l} y = \frac{2}{3}p^3 - p^2 + C \\ x = p^2 - 2p + 2 \end{array} \right., \quad C \in \mathbb{R}; \quad \text{vi)} \quad \left\{ \begin{array}{l} y = p^2 + p \cos p - \sin p + C \\ x = 2p + \cos p \end{array} \right., \quad C \in \mathbb{R}; \\
\text{vii)} \quad & \left\{ \begin{array}{l} y = pe^p - e^p + \frac{p^2}{2} + C \\ x = e^p + p \end{array} \right., \quad C \in \mathbb{R}; \quad \text{viii)} \quad \left\{ \begin{array}{l} y = \frac{2}{3}p^3 + \frac{1}{3}p^{3/2} + C \\ x = p^2 + \sqrt{p} \end{array} \right., \quad C \in \mathbb{R}; \\
\text{ix)} \quad & \left\{ \begin{array}{l} x = 2ap + \frac{3}{2}bp^2 + C \\ y = ap^2 + bp^3 \end{array} \right., \quad C \in \mathbb{R}.
\end{aligned}$$